I'd previously decided that as a new board member I should keep my mouth shut and listen to the others. But knowing a little about Communist tactics from my dealings with the FBI, I suggested that we propose a resolution to the executive committee with language that we knew a Communist couldn't accept and have Olivia submit it in the next meeting the following week and see what happened.

We wrote out what was essentially an innocuous declaration of principles ending with a phrase in which HICCASP's executive board reaffirmed its "belief in free enterprise and the Democratic system and repudiates Communism as desirable for the United States."

The next week, we got together while Olivia attended the executive committee meeting. After an hour or so, the phone rang. It was Olivia. "They voted it down," she said.

She joined us later and said she'd been the only one in favor of our resolution.

It was all the proof we needed: HICCASP had become a Communist front organization hiding behind a few well-intentioned Hollywood celebrities to give it credibility.

The next day, the twelve of us resigned, not only from the board, but the entire organization. We were the last front of respectability for HICCASP and within a week it was out of business—but not the people running it.

They erased the name of HICCASP from the office door but put up the title of a new group—it was the same people with the same objectives behind a new front group.

One night after I gave a speech to the Guild in which I said it was essential that Hollywood join together and beat back the Communist attempt to take over the industry, I arrived a few minutes late for a meeting of the board of the veterans' organization I'd joined which was being held in an abandoned store that had been loaned to us for the meeting.